Proponent's Argument

San Francisco depends on public transit to keep the city livable, power our economy, and connect neighborhoods. Strong transit supports local businesses, reduces congestion, improves air quality, and ensures everyone can get where they need to go affordably – families, seniors, people with disabilities, students, and workers.

Today, Bay Area transit faces a turning point. Without new funding from the Regional Transit Measure, we will experience significant and deep cuts to Muni, BART, and Caltrain – setting us back decades.

Without this measure, Muni could cut service by at least 30%, cancel at least 20 bus routes, end regular evening service, eliminate cable car service, and reduce fare discounts for vulnerable populations. BART could close 15 stations, including Colma, San Bruno, and South San Francisco, and reduce service by 70%. Caltrain could reduce service to one train per hour, and stop running entirely on weekends.

The consequences would impact everyone, making commuting harder, hurt seniors and working families, and slow the City's economic recovery. Thousands of people would be forced every day onto our already congested roads, freeways, and bridges, worsening air pollution, making traffic start earlier and last longer, and resulting in most of us spending more time driving and less time home with our families.

The Regional Transit Measure protects Muni service while preserving regional transit that brings workers, customers, students, and visitors into San Francisco every day.

The Regional Transit Measure protects public transit while requiring local transportation investments – with strong accountability and oversight that requires large transit agencies to show cost savings to continue receiving dedicated operating funding. And it doesn't tax rent, utilities, prescription medicines, or most groceries.

Join us and Vote Yes on the Regional Transit Measure: www.ConnectBayArea.com

Mayor Daniel Lurie
Senator Scott Wiener
City Attorney David Chiu
San Francisco Democratic Party
League of Women Voters of the Bay Area
*Brandy Blau, Zuckerberg San Francisco General Hospital Nurse**
Lian Chang, Transit Advocate

*For identification purposes only; author is signing as an individual and not on behalf of an organization.

Rebuttal to Proponent's Argument

Proponents claim Bay Area transit systems, including SFMTA, face imminent collapse. The budget deficit stems from a manufactured crisis.

Proponents argue revenue is necessary to maintain operations under the Regional Transit Measure framework. However, handing transit agencies an unaccountable, guaranteed blank check removes any incentive for structural reform.

During the pandemic SFMTA gave out pay raises to Staff. Has failed to align service levels with ridership demand. Which remains roughly 15% below pre-pandemic levels. And continue to avoid implementing structural change that would close the deficit. Yet not impact service.

SFMTA hasn't earned San Franciscans trust to be asking for more money at the ballot box. SFMTA Staff hasn't been able to answer questions relating to the budget. If SFMTA can't be transparent and clean up their own mess before asking for more money. Why should voters trust them with more money?

The consequences of the Regional Transit Measure is money taken out of San Francisco residents' hard earned paychecks. At a time when the same people proposing this measure are crying foul about the high cost of living. Why should San Franciscans feel inclined to bail out SFMTA for mismanaging money and overspending?

Voting NO is not anti-transit; it is a demand for accountability. Demand Fixes Before Funding. Require SFMTA to balance their budgets. Without relying on San Franciscans to bail them out.

Vote NO on Regional Transit Measure.

Learn more at https://nonewtransittax.com/solutions/

Griffin Lee, Policy Lead at ConnectedSF

Arguments are the opinions of the authors and have not been checked for accuracy by any official agency.
Arguments are printed as submitted. Spelling and grammatical errors have not been corrected.

Opponent's Argument

The new Regional Transit Measure (RTM) Tax makes life in San Francisco less affordable. Vote NO!

San Francisco already is an expensive place to live. Working class families are barely surviving. **The RTM Tax would make it worse:**

- Prices of groceries, utilities, and rent keep rising.
- Everybody would pay this tax every day, on most things you buy.
- Necessities like prepared **food, clothing,** pet food, and over-the-counter **medicines** are taxed.
- **Seniors, students, the disabled, and low-income neighbors are hurt the most.**

San Francisco's Sales Tax is Too High already.

- RTM is the **LARGEST Sales TAX INCREASE ever in San Francisco's history.**
- RTM is a **NEW TAX** that would raise San Francisco's Sales Tax rate to **9.625%.**
- You'd pay total Sales Tax around $1.00 for every $10.00 of prepared food and nearly $100 for a $1,000 smartphone. *That's too much!*
- As local small businesses struggle, the RTM Tax could scare away customers and **eliminate jobs.**

The new RTM Tax is Too Big ($14,000,000,000.00) **and lasts Too Long** (14 years):

- RTM's Tax would collect nearly a Billion Dollars every year **until *2041.***
- San Francisco unfairly pays *double* the tax rate of other counties.

You can't trust BART, Muni, and Caltrain with more of your tax money:

- You already pay BART, Muni, and Caltrain $100,000,000.00s of sales taxes, property taxes, and bridge tolls every year – on top of fares if you ride.
- They're **grossly mismanaged.** BART and Muni gave pay/benefits above $250,000 to 539 and 338 employees respectively in 2024. RTM's Tax picks *your* pocket to fill *theirs*.
- BART claims it's broke. But an **unnecessary** $13,000,000,000.00 extension with 4 new stations is under construction.
- BART's taxpayer subsidy per passenger increased *729%* from 2019-2024.
- You shouldn't give them more money until they stop their **wasteful spending.**

Vote *NO* on the Regional Transit Measure!

NoNewTransitTax.com

Quentin L. Kopp,
San Francisco Taxpayers Association

Rebuttal to Opponent's Argument

It's undeniable – severe BART, Caltrain and MUNI service cuts would affect all of us in San Francisco – worsening traffic jams and straining transportation options and connections for hundreds of thousands of Bay Area residents.

Please consider the FACTS and don't be misled by half-truths and exaggerations.

FACT: Don't be misled – the Regional Transit Measure does NOT tax rent, utilities, prescription medicines, or most groceries.

FACT: Before supporting the Regional Transit Measure, business groups and local leaders ensured the measure included strong accountability and oversight – BART and MUNI must show cost savings to receive dedicated operating funding.

FACT: Based on detailed analysis, transit agencies have been crystal clear – Without this measure, Muni could face severe service reductions, cancel 20 bus routes, end regular evening service, and reduce fare discounts for vulnerable populations. BART could close 15 stations, including Colma, San Bruno, and South San Francisco, and reduce service by 70%. Caltrain could reduce service to one train per hour, and stop running entirely on weekends.

FACT: Without this measure, commutes would be longer and more unpredictable as people who depend on transit are forced onto already crowded city streets and highways.

FACT: Taxpayers across San Francisco support the Regional Transit Measure, along with stakeholders who don't always agree – business, labor, environmental, and community groups.

VOTE YES on RTM to preserve our Bay Area quality of life for future generations: www.ConnectBayArea.com

Mayor Daniel Lurie
President of the Board of Supervisors Rafael Mandelman
Supervisor Matt Dorsey
Supervisor Jackie Fielder
Supervisor Bilal Mahmood
Supervisor Myrna Melgar
Supervisor Danny Sauter
Supervisor Stephen Sherrill
Former City Controller Ben Rosenfield
San Francisco Firefighters Local 798
San Francisco Senior & Disability Action
San Francisco Transit Riders
Alice B. Toklas LGBTQ Democratic Club
San Francisco Chamber of Commerce

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